



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

MAY

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for JUNE and JULY is

May 20

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



SUNDAY WORSHIP

- 9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.
- 10:15 am Education for all ages
- 11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Minnehaha Happenings in May

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1 Communion 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10:15a Adult Faith Forum 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 6:30p Venturing Crew 7p SAA	2 10a OA 4:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p About the Methodist Church 6:30p Boy Scouts-Full 6:30p UMW Leadership	3 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	4 1p Minnehaha circle 4p Methodicals 5:30p Brighter Minds 5:30p Wed. Night Dinners /Prog. 6:30p Youth Game Night 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	5 Ascension 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Faith & Politics: Civil Discourse 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Brighter Minds Music	6 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	7 9:15a Brighter Minds Music 10a Brighter Minds Music
8 Mother's Day 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10:15a Adult Faith Forum 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	9 10a OA 4:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Finance 6:30p About the Methodist Church 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	10 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 7:15p Brighter Minds Music	11 9a Nokomis Circle 10a Staff Meeting 4p Methodicals 5:30p Brighter Minds 5:30p Wed. Night Dinners /Prog. 6:30p Youth Night 6:45p Chancel Choir	12 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Brighter Minds Music	13 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved	14 9:15a Brighter Minds Music 10a Brighter Minds Music 1:30p Girl Scouts
15 Pentecost 10a Worship with Organ & Choir 11:30a HCI Charge Conference 12p Worship Committee 6:30p Venturing Crew 7p SAA	16 10a OA 4:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts-Full 6:30p Women's Soul Group	17 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters)	18 Confirmation- General Conference 4p Methodicals 5:30p Brighter Minds 5:30p Wed. Night Dinners /Prog. 6:30p Confirmation 6:45p Chancel Choir	19 Confirmation- General Conference 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+C	20 Newsletter items due 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	21 Armed Forces Day 9:15a Brighter Minds Music 10a Brighter Minds Music
22 Trinity Sunday 10a Worship with Organ & Choir 2p Brighter Minds Recitals 4p UMW Meal prep 4p UMW Simpson meal prep 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	23 10a OA 4:15p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p UMW Simpson dinner 5:30p UMW serving @Simpson Shelter 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	24 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 3p Brighter Minds Music 7p SPR 7:15p Brighter Minds Music	25 4p Methodicals 5:30p Brighter Minds 6:45p Chancel Choir	26 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Brighter Minds Music	27 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	28 7a MinneHarvest 9:15a Brighter Minds Music 10a Brighter Minds Music
29 10a Worship with Organ & Choir 6:30p Venturing Crew 7p SAA	30 Memorial Day 10a OA 4:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	31 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 3p Brighter Minds Music				

Worship in May

We finish up the season of Easter in mid-May and move on to Pentecost and the Sundays following. Wear red (in celebration of the Holy Spirit) for our Pentecost worship on May 15, and don't forget that we go to one service at 10:00 for four Sundays, May 15 – June 5.

1st	"Everyone is My Neighbor" <i>Communion, Bibles for Second-graders</i>	Revelation 21:10, 22-26; 22:1-5
8th	"A Vision . . ." <i>Mother's Day</i>	Revelation 22:12-14, 16-17, 20-21
15th	"What Do We Do Now?" <i>One Service at 10:00 am - Pentecost</i>	John 14:8-17, 25-27
22nd	Children's Musical "iAM" <i>One Service at 10:00 am</i>	
29th	"But We Don't Do It That Way" <i>One Service at 10:00 am</i>	Luke 7:1-10

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC— Save the Date

- June 5 One Service 10:00 indoors
Celebration of Graduates
- June 12 Summer worship schedule begins; 9:00 indoors, 10:30 outdoors
- June 15-17 Vacation Bible School
- June 13-17 Music & Drama Camp
- July 25-29 Confirmation Camp at Camp Koronis for all youth who finished 5th grade through 9th grade
- August 7 10:30 Ecumenical Worship at Minnehaha Falls Park
- Sept. 4 10:00 One Service (Labor Day Weekend)
- Sept. 11 10:00 One service outside;
Welcome Sunday
- Oct. 15 Harvest Dinner



*Spring planting-
and clean up!*



"The world's favorite season
is the spring.
All things seem possible in
May."
- Edwin Way Teale

Youth Events in MAY:

4th - Youth Game Night: (Youth Grades 6th-12th) Games start at 6:30 in the Youth Room and goes until 8:00pm.

11th - Youth Night: (Youth Grades 6th-12th) Movie Night! We will be converting the gym into our own private movie theater and enjoy fresh popcorn and ice cream sundaes with our feet up. There is no cost to youth, and the movie starts at 6:30 sharp!

18th - Confirmation Night: (Youth Grades 6th-9th) End of Confirmation Field Trip! The Youth will be going back to Whirly Ball! What the heck is WhirlyBall?!? WhirlyBall is an extremely fun "sport" that combines basketball, hockey, lacrosse, and bumper-cars. That's right, bumper-cars. We need to leave MUMC by 6:15 to make it on time and we will be back around 8:30. Cost is \$15.00 per youth.

18-19th - General Conference Participation: (Youth Grades 6th-12th) The United Methodist General Conference is the top policy making body of the United Methodist Church and meets once every four years. The conference can revise church law, as well as adopt resolutions on current moral, social, public policy and economic issues. It also approves plans and budgets for church-wide programs. This year it will meet in Portland Oregon. Over the past couple years many youth have expressed interest in learning more about it. Since it would cost way too much money to travel to Oregon, we will stay overnight at Minnehaha Wednesday May 18th and spend all day on the 19th streaming live feed of the Conference, learning the processes used, and having discussions on the topics. Cost is \$15 to cover Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner and snacks. Pick-up is Thurs at 7:00pm.

We do understand that this is a school night and they would need permission to miss school on Thursday May 18th to participate. We have never had a youth event during school hours, but we feel this is a very important, exciting, and limited time experience for them.

Future Dates:

- June 5th - Graduation Sunday
- June 13th-17th - Music and Drama Camp - Youth can participate as campers and be in the production or just come to help!
- June 15th-17th: Vacation Bible School - Youth help as Group and classroom leaders
- July 25th-29th: Confirmation Camp at Koronis Campgrounds

Children's Ministries

A few weeks ago, we planted seeds for the Minnehaha garden. The seedlings are doing well, curling up out of their seeds and soil and searching for the light. Over the next few weeks, our children will make sure they are watered, and then we'll move them outside into our garden, where we will continue to take care of them as a community. Before we know it, sunflowers will reach toward the sun, beans and peas will cover the trellises, and we'll see and share in the fruits of our communities labors.



As we watch the children of Minnehaha do the same - ever pushing beyond their safe space, and searching for new light and energy - we have the incredible opportunity and responsibility to tend to them as a community. As the program year comes to a close, it's important to celebrate the growing that's happened, the connections that have been made. It's important to recognize that the tending needs to continue - that the relationships that have been nurtured in Sunday School and Wednesday night programming, in the pews and the Fellowship Hall, are so crucial to our children's health and well-being. Thank you for all that you have done to support our programs, and for tending to our amazing children.

This last month of the 2015-2016 year will be a chance to celebrate this growing and tending:

Sunday, May 1st: We'll present Bible to our second graders during worship.

Sunday, May 22nd: Our Children will lead us in worship - featuring the musical "iAM." One service at 10am, during which time we'll thank the many wonderful faith formation volunteers, and afterwards we'll move our seedlings to the garden, and eat cake!

Other important dates:

Wednesdays, 4th, 11th, & 18th: Wednesday Night Dinners and Programming

Thursdays, 5, 12, 19, 26: Minnehaha Playdate

Sunday, May 15th: One Service at 10am, Following by the HCI Vote

Saturday, May 21st: Rehearsal for Children's Sunday, 9-10:30

Sunday, May 29th: One Service at 10am, Memorial Day

Don't forget to register for camp! The link is available on our website - www.minnehaha.org!

Happy May to you all,

Jenia Strom

Director of Children and Family Ministries



Minnehaha Playdate

For Children 5 & Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

at
Minnehaha United Methodist Church



Highlights from the April 12, 2016 Church Council Meeting

NEW EVENT MEDIA FORM: Communications has created an Event Media Form to make it easier for groups and committees to promote their events. Just fill in your name, group and contact information, as well as a description of the event and additional instructions, and give it to Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix, who is the chair of the Communications committee. An electronic version (PDF) of the form is available on the church website (www.minnehaha.org)...on the right side of the home page. (Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix, Communications)

FUNERAL PLANNING WORKSHEET: The church has a funeral planning worksheet to make it easier to plan a memorial service. It includes questions about your favorite hymns, music, scripture passages and more. Interested? Just go to the church website (www.minnehaha.org) and look for the “Weddings & Memorials/Funerals” section on the right side; click on the “here” link; and, on the new page, click on “Click to download the memorial/funeral planning form.” A copy can even be kept on file at the church. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

TREASURER’S REPORT: The church is up-to-date on all its bills, including apportionments. We’re also benefitting from lower natural gas expenses due to the shorter, warmer winter. Plus, on April 6 the building loan was refinanced at a significantly lower interest rate. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

KIDS’ COMIC BOOK PROJECT: This spring, the children of Minnehaha UMC will be working with comic book artist Kevin Kelly to create their own comic book. The story will focus on the question: How can we make the world a better place? The plan is to have the book finished in time for Children’s Sunday on May 22. (Sarah Emrick, Children’s Council Co-chair; Jenia Strom, Coordinator of Children’s Ministries)

RENTERS USING THE KITCHEN: We occasionally rent out space in our commercial kitchen. These will be listed as reserved on the church calendar. Most times you won’t even notice. But every once in a while you might see a sign on the kitchen doors that says “Reserved for Kitchen Rental.” Just an FYI. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

COFFEE HOUR SIGN-UP: We need people to help with coffee “hour.” This can be anything from setting up the Fellowship Hall to brewing coffee to preparing snacks to greeting people to cleaning up. We’d like as many people to get involved and share in this weekly event. Sign up alone or as a group on the sign-up sheet in the Narthex. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair.)

SERVING AT SIMPSON SHELTER MAY 23: The United Methodist Women (UMW) will once again sponsor serving a meal at Simpson Housing Shelter on Monday, May 23, from 5:45 – 8:30 PM. Talk to Maureen Trepp if you’d like to take part. (Maureen Trepp, UMW)

3 QUESTIONS TO PONDER: During the Council meeting, several questions were presented for discussion: Should we encourage people to bring coffee into church? (Consensus: It’s OK if drinks are contained and have lids, but we shouldn’t promote it; there’s no good place to put cups in the pews.) Should we create a quarterly “snapshot” showing the health of the church? (Consensus: Might be a good idea. Possibly be put in the newsletter. Could include information and trends on attendance, finance, missions, food shelf/MinneHarvest numbers, Sunday school attendance, etc.) Should we consider renting space in the church to another church? (Consensus: We could consider it. The other church must be clear on our mission, vision and values, and that we are a reconciling congregation. And it must not interfere with our own church service and activities.) (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)



"A swarm of bees in May
Is worth a load of hay;
A swarm of bees in June
Is worth a silver spoon;
A swarm of bees in July
Is not worth a fly."
- Rhyme from England

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HEALTHY CHURCH INITIATIVE (HCI) CHARGE CONFERENCE ON MAY 15: On May 15 at 11:00 AM there will be a charge conference to decide whether to accept the five recommendations presented to us by the Conference's Healthy Church Initiative (HCI) team. If you'd like to know more about HCI and the recommendations, contact a member of Minnehaha's HCI team: Dean Ammerman, Becky Sechrist, Valerie Mayer, Shirley Yeoman, Jason Emrick, Jenia Strom, and Mary Vrabel.

NEXT MEETING MAY 10 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for MAY 10 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by *Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair*



Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. This month, we will be gathering on May 12.

United Methodist Basics

There are 2 more classes left on the basics of United Methodism. How a denomination is structured is usually not very interesting, but our particular structure ends up having a big impact on how we make decisions, what our worship is like, and what it means to say you are United Methodist. And, with General Conference (our world-wide gathering that happens every 4 years and makes decisions about our structure for the next 4 years) coming up this month, we'll take a look at what kinds of things will be up for debate and what changes we might be making.

Monday, May 2 – How We Organize Ourselves

Monday, May 9 – What's Going to Happen at General Conference?

Coffee Hour Volunteers

Summer is a great time to test out your volunteer skills with coffee hour. In order to have a robust refreshment time between our services, we need people to set up, to serve, and to clean up our refreshments each Sunday. We are looking both for a coordinator (who could easily organize the whole thing in the pajamas while sitting at their computer), and we are looking for volunteers for each Sunday. Get some friends together, or join an already existing team and volunteer to do set up, serving, or clean up (or all three!) one Sunday a month. The advantage of being part of a team is that if you have something come up for the Sunday you signed up for, you merely let your team know and they can carry on without you for that day. There is an orange sign-up sheet at the church, and a list of duties is there for you to look at as well. Join in on the fun!

Quattro de Mayo Enchilada Dinner

Rick Anderson will be making his famous enchiladas for the Wednesday Night supper on May 4 from 5:30-6:30. Menu will feature chicken & white rice enchiladas, rice and beans, plus packages of enchiladas will be available to take home. Cost for dinner is \$6 for 12 years and up, \$4 for children age 4-11, and under 4 free. Family cap at \$20. Take-away enchiladas are 4 for \$8.



"May and June. Soft syllables, gentle names for the two best months in the garden year: cool, misty mornings gently burned away with a warming spring sun, followed by breezy afternoons and chilly nights. The discussion of philosophy is over; it's time for work to begin."

- Peter Loewer

New Earthkeepers program aims to commission 500 for creation care work

Almost every time Pat Watkins introduces himself as a missionary for the care of God's creation—an official designation through The United Methodist Church's Global Ministries—it piques people's interest. Many have even asked him, "How can I do that?"

This widespread passion around environmental issues prompted the development of a new program that aims to commission 500 people across the U.S. for creation care work within the next seven years. Called Earthkeepers, the program is the brainchild of Watkins, Minnesota deacon Rev. Susan Mullin, and Dan Joranko, a professor at Vanderbilt Divinity School who specializes in community organizing.

Mullin, minister of faith formation and community outreach at Faith United Methodist Church in St. Anthony, was one of six people selected in 2014 to serve on the United Methodist Church's Global Ministries Creation Care Team; she represents all of North America.

"In the past, we've thought of the environmental movement as sort of a sideline," said Mullin, who used to be a professional geologist. "It's an issue you could become involved in but not really at the heart of who we are as Christians. We see more and more signs that there are really significant problems with climate change, with the extinction of species, with what's happening with the oceans. They are a wake-up call. This isn't a side issue; it's a central issue. The way we're living isn't aligned with God's will for creation."

How it works

Mullin describes Earthkeepers as United Methodists who are aware of the ecological challenges in our world today and feel called to be part of a movement to transform the world. They can be laity or clergy, students, part-time or full-time workers, or retirees. (Earthkeepers aren't paid, although some may have a paid job that allows them to work on creation-care projects.)

Earthkeepers will participate in four days of intensive training in creation care theology and community organizing, and then commit to 10 hours per month of providing leadership for a community project or advocacy campaign. Each Earthkeeper would select his or her own project or focus area. They could include efforts like creating community gardens in urban "food deserts," advocating for renewable energy policies, working for environmental justice by cleaning up toxic waste sites, or creating a green team within an annual conference.

Applications for the first group of Earthkeepers will be accepted through June 30, and the goal is to have the first 40 selected by this fall.

Christa Meland is director of communications for the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church.



It's Minnehaha Garden Time!

Our garden is located on the south lawn of the church – in a series of garden beds (raised and not). All are invited to participate in the tending to, enjoyment of, and reaping from the garden.

If you would like to take an active role in maintaining the garden & encouraging enjoyment of the garden, please sign up in the narthex.

You can help by – helping with garden projects (one time, limited in scope projects, being on the regular maintenance crews (signing up for a week (or two) during the growing season to water and weed the garden), and/or by helping plan our monthly garden parties.

Vote on Strengthening Our Core

Hopefully by now you have had a chance to come to one of our information sessions on how we might be able to make ourselves even better as a congregation. The recommendations that come out of our Healthy Church Initiative process need to be voted on before they can become a reality, so please come to the all-church meeting on Sunday, May 15 at 11:00. We'll meet right after the end of the worship service, answer any last-minute questions, and then take a vote. Because the 5 recommendations are related to each other, we will be voting for it as an entire unit rather than 5 separate pieces. If you haven't had a chance to attend one of the information sessions, please be sure to talk to one of the members of the HCI team before May 15: Dean Ammerman, Jason Emrick, Valerie Mayer, Jenia Strom, Mary Vrabel, Shirley Yeoman.



In brief, the 5 recommendations are:

1. Unite around our mission, vision and values
2. Deepen each person's individual spirituality
3. Develop our lay and staff leadership
4. Build relationships with those we serve
5. Build on our Sunday morning experience

One Service Sundays

We will be having one service at 10:00 for these four weeks:

May 15 – one service inside at 10:00 with an all-church meeting to vote on our Healthy Church Initiative proposal at 11:00

May 22 – one service inside at 10:00 for the Children's Musical

May 29 – one service inside at 10:00. Memorial Day weekend. We'll also have our annual practice fire drill following the service

June 5 – one service inside at 10:00 to celebrate our graduating seniors with a special coffee hour in their honor following the service

Wear Red!

Pentecost is the celebration of the birthday of the church, and it is traditional to wear red that day (red symbolizes the flames of the Holy Spirit). This year, we will celebrate Pentecost on May 15 (remember, one service at 10:00 that day), so come and wear some red!

Taizé

For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, and music. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer. Join us on Friday, May 13, at 7:00. We will break for summer and meet again on the second Friday of the month in September!



**United
Methodist
Women**

United Methodist Women

Our plant sale to earn money to support our many missions was again a successful event and we hope you are enjoying your potted and/or hanging plants. We also had a new salad luncheon style, merging our luncheon with that of Epworth Church UMW so we could enjoy new salads and a great variety of bars and make new friends. Many thanks to Diane Enge for sharing her floral expertise with us.

We will be serving once more this spring a meal at Simpson Shelter and we welcome anyone who would like to help out. It will be on Monday, May 23, meeting at Simpson around 5:45 or at church to carpool at 5:15. If you would like to help prepare the meal, that will be on the Sunday before and we are very open to any monetary donations to pay for the dinner. We are very grateful to those who have already given toward this continuing food service in our community. If you can help, please let Maureen Trepp know at 612-724-7620

Our UMW year of activities slows down through the summer months but not until we celebrate our friendships; the day circle will be meeting at Wabun Park on the second Wed. of June, June 8 at 11:30 to share their picnic lunches and the evening circle will meet the next evening, the second Thursday in June, June 9 at Sea Salt restaurant at Minnehaha Falls at 6:30 to stand in line together and eat some of the wonderful seafood sold there. If you are not in any circle, you are still welcome to join us at either of these events.

United Methodist Committee on Relief

We will be taking a special offering on May 1 for the United Methodist Committee on Relief. UMCOR provides both emergency and long-term disaster aid all over the country and all over the world. They are often both the first ones on the scene and the last agency to leave. UMCOR was already on the ground in Haiti in 2010, still working to help people out of extreme poverty due to previous disasters, when the massive earthquake struck. The director of UMCOR, Sam Dixon, was killed when the hotel he was in for a conference collapsed. But UMCOR moved on without its director, providing emergency aid. And UMCOR is still in Haiti, still working with the government and with those in desperate poverty. Whenever any of us gives to a disaster through UMCOR, every dollar we give goes directly to the aid on the ground. And because of the global network of the United Methodist Church, UMCOR is able to utilize local agencies and supplies in almost every country as part of its response. All of this is possible because we support UMCOR administratively. Through our apportionments and through offerings like this one, we give to the infrastructure of UMCOR, paying for salaries, shipping costs of emergency kits, buildings to store supplies until they are needed, etc. Please give generously to UMCOR so that UMCOR can continue to respond to people here and all over the world.



Audrey Schmidt, daughter of Lauren McCarthy and Mike Schmidt, was baptized April 3. Her parents also became members that day!



Planting in Spring

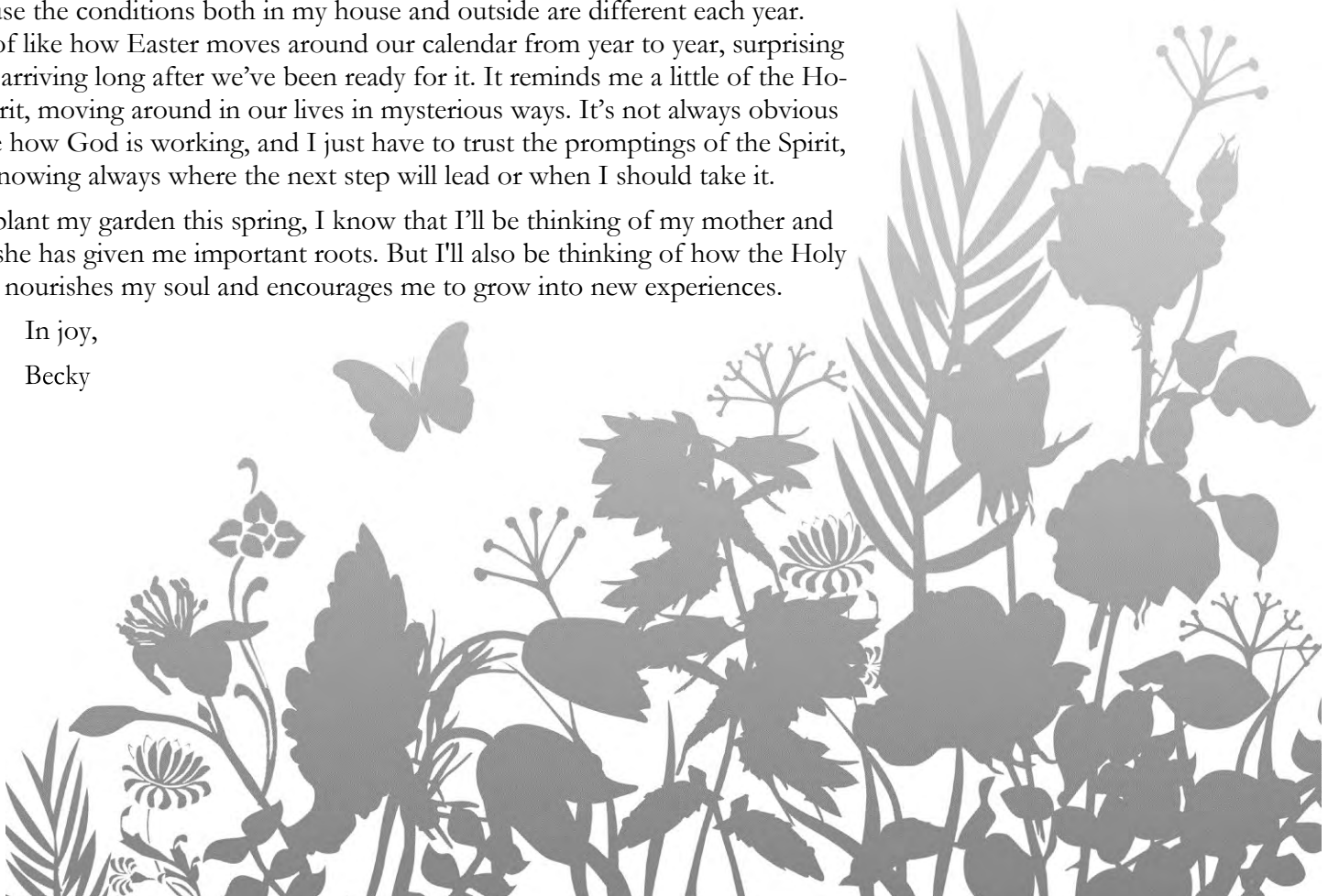
First of all, just a personal note of thanks from me to all of you for your kind words and notes and support following the unexpected death of my mother. It has meant a lot to me as we adjust our lives around the mom-sized hole that now exists there.

My mother passed her love of gardening on to me. I grew up assuming that vegetables always had a little bit of dirt on them, and that they were best when eaten raw, picked right from the garden. My house doesn't have the best yard for a garden, however, so I nurture what I can and buy the rest from the Farmer's Market. Even though I know I can purchase my vegetables elsewhere, I still want to grow a few of my own. Herbs, tomatoes, and peppers are currently residing in my greenhouse downstairs, and soon it will be time to put them outside. When to do that, though, is always a bit of a gamble. If I wait too long, I waste precious growing season time while they sit root bound in my house. Too soon, and they might succumb to a late frost or rebel against the cold soil and refuse to grow for weeks. And it's not like the timing can be the same each year, because the conditions both in my house and outside are different each year. Sort of like how Easter moves around our calendar from year to year, surprising us or arriving long after we've been ready for it. It reminds me a little of the Holy Spirit, moving around in our lives in mysterious ways. It's not always obvious to me how God is working, and I just have to trust the promptings of the Spirit, not knowing always where the next step will lead or when I should take it.

As I plant my garden this spring, I know that I'll be thinking of my mother and how she has given me important roots. But I'll also be thinking of how the Holy Spirit nourishes my soul and encourages me to grow into new experiences.

In joy,

Becky





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5/16



- **Strengthening our Core**
- **Council Report**
- **Summer Programs**
- **Spring Plant Sale**

Summer Programs at Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Vacation Bible School: Surf Shack: Catch the Wave of God's Amazing Love

June 15th-June 17th 9-11:30am

A morning program for children in preschool through fourth grade

An opportunity for kids to grow and learn through games, arts & crafts, music, and more. Extended afternoon daycare available.

Music and Drama Camp

June 13th-June 17th 9am-3pm

An all-day camp for children who have completed fourth through eighth grade

Campers will spend the week working on all aspects of a musical production, which will be performed on the evening of Friday, June 17th

Register at our website today!